

## **Kohsar University Murree (KUM) – ORIC Commercialization Policy**

### **1. Purpose**

The purpose of this policy is to provide a clear framework for the commercialization of research outputs generated by faculty, researchers, and students at Kohsar University Murree (KUM). This includes the transfer of knowledge, technology, and innovations to industry and society, promoting entrepreneurship, supporting startup ventures, and generating revenue for both the inventor and the University.

This policy ensures compliance with HEC guidelines on intellectual property, commercialization, and industry collaboration while providing a practical model for a growing university.

### **2. Scope**

This policy applies to:

1. All faculty, staff, researchers, and students of KUM engaged in research or innovation.
2. Any intellectual output, innovation, or invention developed using University resources, infrastructure, funding, or collaborative programs.
3. Consultancy projects linked to commercialization where KUM infrastructure, labs, or branding is involved.
4. Startups, incubated ventures, or commercial collaborations facilitated by ORIC.

**Note:** Personal consultancy or research activities using no University resources or branding are exempt from this policy. Such activities are outside KUM's financial interest.

### **3. Definitions**

1. **Commercialization:** Process of converting research outputs, inventions, or innovations into marketable products, services, or solutions.
2. **Invention:** Any novel device, methodology, software, or product developed by faculty, researchers, or students.
3. **Revenue Sharing:** Division of income generated from commercialization between the inventor(s) and KUM.
4. **ORIC:** Office of Research, Innovation, and Commercialization responsible for managing intellectual assets and commercialization processes.
5. **Startup/Spin-off:** A legally registered entity based on KUM-generated research or intellectual property.

### **4. Objectives**

1. Promote transfer of knowledge and innovation from KUM to industry and society.
2. Support faculty, researchers, and students in protecting their intellectual assets.
3. Encourage the establishment of startups and entrepreneurial ventures.
4. Generate sustainable revenue for the University while rewarding innovators.
5. Ensure compliance with HEC and national policies for research commercialization.

## 5. Commercialization Process

### Step 1: Disclosure

- All inventions or research outputs intended for commercialization must be disclosed to ORIC using the **Invention Disclosure Form (IDF)**.
- ORIC will evaluate the novelty, market potential, and feasibility of commercialization.

### Step 2: Intellectual Property Protection

- ORIC will guide the inventors in filing patents, copyrights, trademarks, or industrial designs.
- University support for IP filing may include legal, administrative, and financial assistance.

### Step 3: Market Assessment & Licensing

- ORIC may conduct a feasibility study and market assessment.
- Commercialization options include:
  - Licensing to industry or startups
  - Joint ventures with industry partners
  - Formation of a startup or spin-off

### Step 4: Revenue Collection & Sharing

- Revenue generated from commercialization (licensing fees, royalties, equity in startups, or consultancy linked to University resources) will be shared as follows:

| Beneficiary | Share % |
|-------------|---------|
|-------------|---------|

|             |     |
|-------------|-----|
| Inventor(s) | 70% |
|-------------|-----|

|                 |     |
|-----------------|-----|
| ORIC/University | 30% |
|-----------------|-----|

- **Note:** The above ratio may be adjusted for multi-inventor or collaborative projects with prior agreement.
- Revenue from projects using external funds (grants, industry sponsorship) will be managed as per funder guidelines in addition to this policy.

### Step 5: Commercialization Agreements

- ORIC will formalize agreements including licensing contracts, equity participation, royalties, and non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) with external partners.
- All agreements must include protection of University reputation and compliance with HEC standards.

## 6. Startup & Incubation Support

1. Faculty, researchers, or students may form startups based on KUM IP with ORIC support.
2. ORIC may provide:
  - Mentorship and training in entrepreneurship
  - Access to University labs, equipment, and facilities

- Networking with investors and industry partners
- 3. Startups incubated at KUM may be granted equity support or preferential licensing terms.
- 4. University may take a maximum **10% equity stake** in incubated startups where ORIC facilities are utilized.

## **7. Consultancy Linked to Commercialization**

1. Consultancy projects using University infrastructure or labs are considered part of commercialization. Revenue is subject to the ORIC revenue-sharing model.
2. Consultancy projects not using University resources, branding, or funding are considered personal activities and are exempt from University revenue interest.
3. All consultancy agreements must be submitted to ORIC for record-keeping and compliance with HEC guidelines.

## **8. Conflict of Interest**

1. Inventors and KUM personnel must disclose any financial, personal, or professional interests in commercialization ventures.
2. ORIC will ensure that commercialization agreements do not compromise academic integrity, research ethics, or University reputation.

## **9. Compliance & Reporting**

1. ORIC will maintain a centralized database of disclosures, patents, licenses, startups, and revenue records.
2. Annual commercialization report will be submitted to the Vice Chancellor and the Board of Governors, highlighting:
  - Patents filed
  - Licenses executed
  - Startups incubated
  - Revenue generated
3. Non-compliance with this policy may result in restricted access to ORIC support or disciplinary measures as per University regulations.

## **10. Amendments**

- ORIC, with the approval of the Vice Chancellor, reserves the right to revise this policy to reflect changes in HEC, COMSATS, or NUST guidelines, emerging commercialization trends, or University priorities.